- **Context**—XACML supports rich contextual data within the "environment" category of requests. Elements such as time of day, IP address, device posture, or other metadata can be used in conditions. This makes it effective in compliance or risk-sensitive environments where external context significantly influences access decisions.

Taken together, XACML's approach to PARC reflects its roots in attribute-based access control: everything—principals, actions, resources, and context—is modeled as attributes and evaluated through rule conditions. While this gives it a great deal of expressive power, it also makes policies more challenging to write, read, and maintain. Without native support for types, relationships, or reusable structures, policy authors are left to manage complexity through raw XML and consistent naming conventions.

The biggest barrier to adoption for XACML wasn't the attribute model itself; it was the overall developer experience. Writing policies in verbose XML, lacking effective tools for testing and debugging, and integrating with heavyweight policy decision infrastructure all made XACML feel disconnected from modern development workflows. It laid important groundwork for separating policy from code, but ultimately highlighted the need for more user-friendly, embeddable, and developer-friendly policy systems.